

them. We can't be conscious of what's bringing us benefit without taking the time to identify it. To do this, it takes practice. A few of our favorite ways to weave gratitude into our day-to-day include:

Journaling Gratitude. This is a five-minute exercise you can choose to do for just two weeks or as an everyday practice. It involves writing down one to five things you are grateful for that day. You can think about questions like: What *do* I have as a result of this current season? In what ways am I experiencing the benefits of the 4 F's (faith, family, friends, fulfilling work). What benefits have I received *today*?

Doing this regularly can help you become more aware about your space, current season, and how you move through life. It gives clearer focus on what's actually important and can even help reset your thoughts. Try it. And take notice of your level of overall satisfaction after a few weeks.

Triggering Gratitude. This one involves the senses and requires moments of slowing down. Similar to the pause we can create before buying something, we can use our senses to trigger a gratitude pause. Like the sun on your face in the morning, the smell of coffee, the voice of someone you love, the feel of something warm; any of it is something to be grateful for in and of itself. Each one can also be the catalyst for listing off even more things you are grateful for about your life and the people around you. You decide what you want your triggers to be and allow each one to be an opportunity for thankfulness.

Sharing Gratitude. You can invite others into your process by sharing with them the good things you are noticing around you. You can also tell them how glad you are for their friendship, love, care, support, whatever it is you receive from them, whether in-person or through a hand-written note. When you include others in your practice of gratitude, it not only solidifies your thoughts further, it encourages you to keep cultivating this grateful mindset. And others receive the benefit of feeling noticed and appreciated.

As you consider all that you have to be grateful for in your present season, also be sure to acknowledge the hard work you've already done to improve your spending and live a rich life beyond the monetary definition. You can celebrate your efforts and successes. All the times you said no to unnecessary stuff, *and* the times you said yes to decisions that others weren't. Your experience is not anyone else's and your unique journey is worth valuing and appreciating.